Dr Ayman Ayad

Sector Manager, Water and Social Infrastructure · EU Delegation to Egypt

Water economist and infrastructure finance specialist · 20+ years · Egypt and the Southern Neighbourhood

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I lead the European Union's water and social infrastructure portfolio in Egypt, a book of more than €4 billion that I have grown more than eightfold in under five years. My work sits where public policy meets project finance: shaping operations with government, aligning EU grants with lending from European and multilateral banks, and keeping 20+ programmes on track from origination to delivery. I started as a utility engineer in Alexandria, and that field grounding still shapes how I judge a project.

€4bn+
portfolio under management, incl. ~€600m EU grants

8×
portfolio growth in under 5 years, across 5 sub-sectors

€1.2bn+
prospective co-finance mobilised via Team Europe

35m+
citizens reached by 21 projects in Egypt, Jordan, Lebanon

PORTFOLIO LEADERSHIP

- **Built a multi-sector portfolio.** Diversified a water-only book into five sub-sectors: water and wastewater, irrigation and drainage, solid waste, social housing, and agriculture and food security.
- **Initiated the Team Europe Initiative** on Water and Food Security in Egypt, lining up €1.2bn+ in prospective blended finance, guarantees and co-financing.
- **Runs 20+ programmes end to end**: origination, appraisal, due diligence, financing documents, field monitoring and bottleneck resolution with project promoters.
- **Advanced €500m+ in PPP pipeline** commitments, with transaction-advisory coordination alongside IFC and AfDB.
- **Convenes the sector.** Co-chair of the Water Development Partners Group since 2014, aligning ministries, MDBs, UN agencies and bilateral donors.
- **Flagship operations:** Alexandria West WWTP, Gabal Asfar and Fayoum wastewater expansions, Kitchener Drain programme, National Drainage Programme.

FINANCING PARTNERS

EIB · EBRD · KfW · AFD · World Bank · AfDB · IFC · UKEF

CAREER PATH

2018 – present
Sector Manager, Water and Social Infrastructure
EU Delegation to Egypt

2013 – 2018
Programme Manager, Water and Utilities
EU Delegation to Egypt · 10 financing decisions, ~€2bn investment

2009 – 2012
Water Resources Consultant
Mott MacDonald · CEDARE · Egyptian Consulting Office

2005 – 2013
Senior GIS and Hydraulic Analysis Expert
Alexandria Water Company

CREDENTIALS

PhD Irrigation Engineering and Hydraulics, Ain Shams University, cum laude
MSc and **BSc**, Alexandria University
PMP · Chartered Civil Engineer
Visiting Associate Professor, Ain Shams University (MSc IWRM)
Arabic (native) · English (C2) · French (A2)

EXPERTISE

Portfolio management · Blended finance · PPP structuring · Water economics · Due diligence · WEFE nexus · Policy dialogue · Climate resilience

Views expressed are personal.

PORTFOLIO LEADERSHIP AT A GLANCE

Twenty years building Egypt's water infrastructure, from utility to EU portfolio

Dr Ayman Ayad · Sector Manager, Water and Social Infrastructure, EU Delegation to Egypt

€4bn+

water, social infrastructure and WEFE portfolio under management, including about €600m in EU grant financing

€1.2bn+

prospective blended finance and co-finance lined up through the Team Europe Initiative

€500m+

PPP and private-sector pipeline commitments advanced

20+

programmes managed across the WEFE nexus

21

major projects in Egypt, Jordan and Lebanon

35m+

citizens benefiting

PORTFOLIO GROWTH



8× growth

in less than five years as Sector Manager, while widening the scope beyond water

FINANCING PARTNERS

EIB · EBRD · KfW · AFD · World Bank · AfDB · IFC · UKEF

Co-chair, **Water Development Partners Group** since 2014

FROM ONE SECTOR TO FIVE

1. Water and wastewater
2. Irrigation and drainage
3. Solid waste
4. Social housing
5. Agriculture and food security

CAREER PATH

- **2005** — Alexandria Water Company
- **2009** — Consulting: Mott MacDonald, CEDARE
- **2013** — EU Delegation, Programme Manager
- **2018** — Sector Manager
- **2022** — PhD, water economics
- **2025** — Visiting Assoc. Professor

FLAGSHIP OPERATIONS

Alexandria West WWTP · Gabal Asfar Wastewater Expansion · Fayoum Wastewater Expansion · Kitchener Drain Programme · National Drainage Programme

Dr Ayman Ayad · linkedin.com/in/aymanayadr

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RESEARCH AND PUBLICATIONS

From pipe networks to national water policy

Peer-reviewed work on network optimisation, non-revenue water and integrated water resources management in Egypt. Each journal article links to its DOI.

6	5	1	2013–22
peer-reviewed journal articles	international conference papers	book and 1 PhD thesis	publication span

WATER RESOURCES MANAGEMENT AND POLICY

IWRM · land reclamation · investment planning

2022 — **Economic-Based Investment Planning for Integrated Water Resources Management**
Ayad, A. · PhD thesis, Faculty of Engineering, Ain Shams University, Cairo · cum laude
Doctoral thesis

2021 — **An Assessment of the Integrated Water Resources Management in Egypt**
Ayad, A., Khalifa, A., El Fawy, M. · *Journal of Environmental Treatment Techniques*, 9(4), 751–768
doi.org/10.47277/JETT/9(4)768 ↗

2021 — **Holistic Assessment of the Egyptian National Land Reclamation Project from the View of IWRM**
Ayad, A., Khalifa, A., El Fawy, M. · *Journal of Environmental Treatment Techniques*, 9(4), 776–787
doi.org/10.47277/JETT/9(4)787 ↗

WATER NETWORKS, OPTIMISATION AND NRW

hydraulics · genetic algorithms · GIS

2021 — **An integrated approach for non-revenue water reduction in water distribution networks based on field activities, optimisation, and GIS applications** OPEN ACCESS
Ayad, A., Khalifa, A., El Fawy, M., Moawad, A. · *Ain Shams Engineering Journal*, 12(4), 3509–3520
doi.org/10.1016/j.asej.2021.04.007 ↗

2018 — **Integrated approach for the optimal design of pipeline networks** OPEN ACCESS
Ayad, A., Awad, H., Yassin, A. · *Alexandria Engineering Journal*, 57(1), 87–96
doi.org/10.1016/j.aej.2016.10.008 ↗

2013 — **Parametric analysis for genetic algorithms handling parameters** OPEN ACCESS
Ayad, A., Awad, H., Yassin, A. · *Alexandria Engineering Journal*, 52(1), 99–111
doi.org/10.1016/j.aej.2012.10.007 ↗

2013 — **Developed hydraulic simulation model for water pipeline networks** OPEN ACCESS
Ayad, A., Awad, H., Yassin, A. · *Alexandria Engineering Journal*, 52(1), 43–49
doi.org/10.1016/j.aej.2012.11.005 ↗

2013 — **Economical Design of Pipeline Networks**
Ayad, A. · Book · LAP LAMBERT Academic Publishing, Saarbrücken
Book · print

Conference papers, 2011–2012: five papers presented at international water conferences, including the Sustainable Water Supply and Sanitation Conference (Cairo), the Nile water symposium, the water resources conference in Marrakech (two papers) and the drinking water conference in Hangzhou. Proceedings published on CD-ROM.